

0.0.1 Sakka's Questions (excerpt)

sakkapañhasuttaṃ (excerpt)

1. “Do you, O Ruler of the devas, recall having asked these questions of other samanas and brahmanas?”

abhiñānāsi no tvaṃ devānaminda, ime pañhe aññe samaṇabrāhmaṇe pucchitā”ti.

2. “I do recall, O Bhante, having asked these questions of other samanas and brahmanas.”

“abhiñānamahaṃ bhante, ime pañhe aññe samaṇabrāhmaṇe pucchitā”ti.

3. “But, O Ruler of the devas, if it is not troublesome for you, speak as to how they answered.”

“yathākathaṃ pana te devānaminda byākāṃsu, sace te agaru bhāsassū”ti.

4. “It is not troublesome for me, O Bhante, of where the Auspicious One is seated or someone like the Auspicious One.”

“na kho me bhante, garu yatthassa bhagavā ni-sinno bhagavantarūpo vā”ti.

5. “Well then, O Ruler of the devas, speak.”

“tena hi devānaminda bhāsassū”ti.

6. Those who, O Bhante, that I conceived to be “Samanas and brahmanas who are forest dwellers in secluded resting places,” to them I approached. Having approached, I asked these questions. They were not able to answer the questions asked. Being unable to answer, they asked me a question in return: “What is your name venerable sir?” When asked, I answer to them: “I, Dear sir, am Sakka, Ruler of the devas.” They then asked a further question of me: “But having done what kamma, O venerable sir, was it possible for you to attain this rulership of the devas?” To them I taught the dhamma as I have heard and learned it. They surely became pleased with just that much [rejoicing]: “We have seen Sakka, Ruler of the devas and he has answered the questions we asked him.” “Those on the other hand become my disciples, instead of I being theirs. But I, O Bhante, am a disciple of the Auspicious One, a stream-enterer, not subject to the woeful plane, on a fixed course, destined for supreme awakening.”

“ye svāhaṃ¹ bhante, maññāmi samaṇabrāhmaṇā
ārañṇakā pantasenāsanā’ti, tyāhaṃ upasaṅkami-
tvā ime pañhe pucchāmi. te mayā puṭṭhā na sam-
pāyanti, asampāyantā mamaṃ yeva paṭipucchanti’
ko nāmo āyasmā?’ti. tesāhaṃ puṭṭho byākaromi:

“ahaṃ kho mārisa, sakko devānamindo’ti. te mamaṃ yeva uttarim paṭipucchanti ‘kiṃ paṇāyasmā devānaminda kammaṃ katvā imaṃ ṭhānaṃ patto’ti. tesāhaṃ yathāsutaṃ yathāpariyattaṃ dhammaṃ desemi. te tāvatakeneva attamanā honti ‘sakko ca no devānamindo diṭṭho yañca no apucchimha tañca no byākāsī’ti. te aññadatthu mamaṃ yeva sāvakā sampajjanti, na cāhaṃ tesam. ahaṃ kho pana bhante, bhagavato sāvako sotāpanno avinipātadhammo niyato sambodhiparāyaṇo”ti.

7. “Do you recall, O Ruler of the devas, having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here?”

“abhiṇāsi no tvaṃ devānaminda, ito pubbe evarūpaṃ veda paṭilābhaṃ somanassapaṭilābhanti?”

8. “I do recall, O Bhante, having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here.”

“abhiṇāmahāṃ bhante, ito pubbe evarūpaṃ veda paṭilābhaṃ somanassapaṭilābhanti.”

9. “But you, O Ruler of the devas, in what way do you recall having gained such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the past from here?”

“yathākatham pana tvaṃ devānaminda, abhijānāsi ito pubbe evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābham somanassa-paṭilābhanti?”

10. Once in the past, O Bhante, the devas and the asuras were arrayed for a battle. And in that battle, O Bhante, the devas were victorious and the asuras were defeated. Of me, O Bhante, having been victorious in that battle, as a victor in battle, this occurred: “Now, just that which is the food of the devas, and that which is the food of the asuras, the devas will enjoy them both.” But for me O Bhante, such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness in the sphere of violence, in the sphere of swords, does not lead to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana. But for me O Bhante, having heard this Dhamma of the Auspicious One, such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness not in the sphere of violence, not in the sphere of swords, leads exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana,”

“bhūtapubbaṃ bhante, devāsurasaṅgāmo samupabyūḷho ahosi. tasmim kho pana bhante, saṅgāme devājinimso, asurā parājijimso. tassa mayhaṃ bhante, taṃ saṅgāmaṃ abhivijinitvā vijitasāṅgāmassa etadahosi: ‘yā ceva dāni dibbā ojā yā ca asurā ojā ubhayamettha devā paribhuñjissan-

tatī ti. so kho pana me bhante, vedapaṭilābho somanassapaṭilābho sadaṇḍāvacaro sasatthāvacaro na nibbidāya na virāgāya na nirodhāya na upasamāya na abhiññāya na sambodhāya na nibbānāya saṃvattati. yo kho pana me ayaṃ bhante, bhagavato dhammaṃ sutvā vedapaṭilābho somanassapaṭilābho, so adaṇḍāvacaro asatthāvacaro ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattatī”ti.

11. “But considering what benefit, do you, O Ruler of the devas, declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness?”

“kiṃ pana tvaṃ devānaminda, atthavaśaṃ sampassamāno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ somanassa paṭilābhaṃ pavedesī?”ti.

12. “Considering six benefits, O Bhante, do I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.”

“cha kho ahaṃ bhante, atthavase sampassamāno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ somanassapaṭilābhaṃ pavedemī”ti.

“Remaining just here,
for me existing as a deva being;
yet gained is renewed life for me,

You should know thus, dear Sir.”

“idheva tiṭṭhamānassa,
devabhūtaṃ me sato;
punarāyu ca me laddho,
evaṃ jānāhi mārisā”ti.

13. Seeing this first benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, paṭhamam atthavasam
samppassamāno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābham soma-
nassapaṭilābham pavedemi.

Having passed from the deva group,
having abandoned the non-human life;
unconfused, I will enter a womb,
where my mind delights.

cuto’haṃ diviyā kāyā,
āyus hitvā amānusaṃ;
amūḷho gabbhamessāmi,
yattha me ramatī mano.

14. Seeing this second benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, dutiyam atthavasam sam-
passamāno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābham somanas-

sapaṭilābhaṃ pavedemi.

That I, with unconfused wisdom,
dwelling delighting in the Instructions;
will dwell by the know-how,
contemplative and mindful.

svāhaṃ amūlhapaññassa,
viharaṃ sāsane rato;
ñāyena viharissāmi,
sampajāno patissato.

15. Seeing this third benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, tatiyaṃ atthavaṣaṃ sam-
passamāno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ somanas-
sapaṭilābhaṃ pavedemi.

And faring by the know-how,
if there will be supreme awakening;
I will dwell as one with final knowledge,
and just that will be the end.

ñāyena me carato ca,
sambodhi ce bhavissati;
aññathā viharissāmi,
sveva manto bhavissati.

16. Seeing this fourth benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, catutthaṃ atthavaṣaṃ
sampaṣṣamāno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ soma-
nassapaṭilābhaṃ pavedemi.

Having passed away from the human group,
having abandoned the human life;
I will again become a deva,
in the highest deva world [sudhāvāsa].

cuto'haṃ mānusa kāyā,
āyuṃ hitvāna mānusaṃ;
puna deva bhavissāmi,
devalokamhi uttamo.

17. Seeing this fifth benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, pañcamāṃ atthavaṣaṃ
sampaṣṣamāno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ soma-
nassapaṭilābhaṃ pavedemi.

Those that are more sublime than the devas,
the glorious Akaniṭṭha [realm];
that will be my abode,
my final state of being.

te paṇītatarā devā,
 akaniṭṭhā yasassino;
 antime vattamānamhi,
 so nivāso bhavissati.

18. Seeing this sixth benefit, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

imaṃ kho ahaṃ bhante, chaṭṭhaṃ atthavaṣaṃ
 sampassamāno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ soma-
 nassapaṭilābhaṃ pavedemi.

19. Seeing these six benefits, venerable sir, I declare such an acquisition of feeling, an acquisition of happiness.

ime kho ahaṃ bhante, cha atthavase sampassa-
 māno evarūpaṃ vedapaṭilābhaṃ somanassapaṭi-
 lābhaṃ pavedemi.

